
Paper 2, Option 2C.2:

Russia in revolution, 1894–1924

Overview

This option comprises a study in depth of the causes, course and consolidation of the Russian Revolution of 1917, which had a momentous effect on twentieth-century Russia and throughout the modern world.

Students will gain an in-depth understanding of revolutionary activity in Russia in the years 1894 to 1917, the response of successive governments to opposition to their rule, and the reasons for the successful consolidation of the revolution of October 1917 under Lenin and the Bolsheviks.

Key topics	Content
1 The rule of Nicholas II, 1894–1905	• The nature of autocratic rule: the Tsarist principles of autocracy, nationality and orthodoxy; the oppression of nationalities; anti-semitism; the Okhrana. • Opposition to Tsarism: unrest among peasants and workers; middle-class opposition and the League of Liberation; the Socialist Revolutionaries and the Social Democrats; reasons for the lack of success of opposition groups. • The 1905 Revolution: the impact of the Russo-Japanese war; Bloody Sunday; the spread of revolutionary activity among peasants, workers and national minorities; the St. Petersburg Soviet. • Nicholas II's response: the failure of the August Manifesto; the October Manifesto and the response of opposition groups; the crushing of the Moscow Uprising; the extent of the recovery of Tsarist power.
2 The end of Romanov rule, 1906–17	• Change and continuity in government: the Fundamental Law; the radicalism of the first two dumas; Nicholas II's relations with the dumas, 1906–14; the nature of Tsarist government and royal power in 1914. • Repression and reform, 1906–14: Stolypin's repression and the restoration of stability; actions against revolutionary parties; reform of agricultural landholdings and emigration to Siberia; the Lena goldfields massacre 1912. • The impact of the First World War: the state of the armed forces in 1914; economic problems including inflation and supplies for cities. The roles of Nicholas, Alexandra and Rasputin; the Progressive Bloc and Zemgor.

Key topics	Content
3 The Provisional government and its opponents, February–October 1917	• The nature of dual power: the political complexion of the Provisional government; the extent of its power and support; the aims and membership of the Petrograd Soviet; early political reforms. • Opposition to the Provisional government: conflicting attitudes on the continuation of the war; Lenin's return to Russia and the April Theses; the Milyukov crisis; the June Offensive and the July Days. • The second Provisional government, July–October: Kerensky as Prime Minister; the membership of the new government; problems in industry and agriculture; the Kornilov affair and its impact on the government and the Bolsheviks. • The October Revolution: Lenin's influence on the Central Committee; the Constituent Assembly elections; Trotsky and the Military Revolutionary Committee; the events of 24–26 October; the formation of the Bolshevik government.
4 Defending the Bolshevik revolution, October 1917–24	• Consolidating Bolshevik power: the closing of the Constituent Assembly; making peace at Brest-Litovsk; the formation of the Cheka; attacks on Bolshevik opponents; the Red Terror. • Bolshevik economic policies: state capitalism; War Communism; the Tambov rising and the Kronstadt mutiny; economic and political results of the New Economic Policy; the ban on factions 1921. • Defeat of domestic enemies: the Social Revolutionaries, national minorities and the Whites; Trotsky and the Red Army; the geography of the civil war; the defeat of Kolchak, Denikin and Yudenich. • Foreign intervention in Russia: reasons, nature and extent of intervention; the impact of war weariness and the lack of support in the west for intervention; the end of intervention.

Route D: Challenges to the authority of the state in the late eighteenth and nineteenth centuries

Overview

Students taking Route D will study:

- *Paper 1, Option 1D: Britain, c1785–c1870: democracy, protest and reform*

and **either**:

- *Paper 2, Option 2D.1: The unification of Italy, c1830–70*

or:

- *Paper 2, Option 2D.2: The unification of Germany, c1840–71.*

The options in Route D are linked by the theme of challenges to the authority of the state, which was manifested in different ways such as protests and the growth of nationalist sentiment. This period was one in which ordinary people, often with strong leadership, were instrumental in changing the nature of government in their respective countries. It was also a time of major political developments, when state authority in Britain, Italy and Germany was changed dramatically.

Studying two different countries allows students to develop a greater appreciation of the nature of power and authority in the given period, and to understand the similarities and contrasts between them (although students will not be required to answer comparative questions that link the breadth and the chosen depth option).